

## All about me

- BORN: 1883
- DIED: 1971
- NATIONALITY: French
- FACTOID: I lived in the Ritz hotel for more than 30 years.
- IN A NUTSHELL: My mother died of tuberculosis, and my father left the family, so I spent six years in an orphanage.

Chanel's clothes were custom-made using only the highest quality fabric.

## Trendsetter

Coco opened her first shop in Paris, France, in 1909. At first she sold hats, but soon she started selling **luxury clothes**, fabrics, and jewelry. Coco introduced styles to the fashion world that were seen to be **RADICAL** at the time, such as the bobbed haircut, trousers for women, bathing suits, and the **little black dress**. She even (accidentally) made the sun tan fashionable when she got sunburned while on holiday.

### By the way...

my real name was Gabrielle Bonheur Chanel. After I left the orphanage, I worked as a cabaret singer, where I became known as "Coco."

## Going global

Coco's little fashion boutique became one of the most **profitable and iconic** fashion houses of all time. Her most famous product was a **perfume**, Chanel No 5, which made her one of the richest women in the world. Even today, she is regarded as an **ICON OF STYLE AND ELEGANCE**, and her classic designs still influence fashion.

Chanel No 5 is still the world's bestselling perfume.

# Coco Chanel

The woman who **STYLED** the 20th century, and changed the face of fashion

